

- » **Starting to invest early.** When you look at investment returns, one of the biggest drivers is your start time. The difference between beginning at twenty and thirty years old can be millions of dollars. If you didn't start until now though, just remember: The best time was twenty years ago, but the second-best time is today.
- » **Choosing long-term, low-cost investments.** Forget the usual hype you see on TV, with people frenetically running around the stock exchange. Real investing is simple and boring. It typically involves index funds with very low fees. And they're well diversified and properly allocated. This decision alone is worth more than all the lattes you will buy in your entire lifetime—*combined*.
- » **Earning money on the side.** There's a limit to how much you can cut, but no limit to how much you can earn. This is why I encourage you to focus on opening additional income streams based on the skills you already possess.
- » **Building the skill of spending.** Yes, spending your money meaningfully is a skill, and ultimately one of the most important you'll ever learn. Have you built a system to ensure you're using money to create your Rich Life? Otherwise, why are we all working so hard and saving and investing?

If you look at each of those Big Wins within personal finances, you'll see that they are huge opportunities. Each one takes work to set up. But once you build it, it produces rewards for years and years to come. Once you decide on the most important areas in your life, you can "drill down" to focus on the key actions that will get you the biggest results.

This is a very different way to look at your life. It takes some time to establish. But it allows you to focus on what's really important rather than what's merely urgent. Spending time identifying my Big Wins has given me a sense of clarity, purpose, and calm. I believe your Big Wins can do the same for you.